



DIGITAL CAMERAS

Once things get into the digital realm, it naturally gains advantages such as portability, ease of archiving and most importantly, no loss of quality even after duplication. Though digital cameras have been around for some time now, their technology and functionality has come to the fore only in the recent past. With denser CCDs, smaller form factors, more features, exhaustive options, longer battery life and, most importantly, a fall in prices, digital cameras are slowly but surely creeping into the price bracket of the amateur shutter-bug.

Getting in focus

The optical parameters of a digital camera are identical to those of conventional cameras. This includes the focal length of the camera, the optical zoom, the exposure modes, the manual and auto focussing methods and metering modes. However, more important than these are parameters such as the CCD sensor, the amount of memory for storage, the LCD viewfinder, battery type and menu navigation system.

A camera with a 1.3 megapixel CCD sensor is a good place to start for beginners—their resolutions go up to 1280x1024 at 72-dpi. Though not suited for printing, it is adequate for viewing and sharing them online. For basic print photo needs, you need at least a 2.1 megapixel CCD—this allows a resolution up to 1600x1200, which is adequate for postcard-sized prints.

All digital cameras use some form of Flash

Nominees

Name	Contacts	Comments
Fuji FinePix 2800 Zoom	Jindal Photo films Ltd, Ph: 022-28514441	Boasting of a 6x optical zoom, this 2.1 megapixel camera sports controls for great photography for amateurs
Nikon CoolPix 800	Aver Software Technologies, Ph: 022-26320472	Sporting a 2x optical and 2.1 megapixel camera, this 2.11 megapixel camera boasted of a large number of options for creative photography and many controls over manual

storage. Opt for at least 8 MB of Flash memory or higher if you can afford, the better. Optical zoom gives clear up shots compared to digital zoom. Digital cameras are notorious for chewing up batteries. Opt for Lithium Ion batteries—they are lighter and offer greater capacities; the next best are NiMH batteries.

And the award goes to...

The camera that shone bright in our year was the formidable Olympus C-2100 Ultra Zoom. With its 2.11 megapixel sensor and various modes for metering, white balance, the camera captured sharp images. The icing on the cake was the optical zoom and class-leading 27x digital zoom allowed you to get really close and personal with your subject. With a wide array of features, excellent build quality and brilliant image performance, this camera turned out to be an undisputed winner.



Olympus Camedia C-2100 Ultra Zoom
Komal International,
Ph: 022-22614015

The verdict: This 2.11 megapixel camera, with its outstanding 10x optical zoom and 27x digital zoom, delivered unbeatable picture quality with plenty of features for creative digital photography



IMAGE EDITING

Adobe Photoshop 7

The most-loved image editing software has just become better. Adobe Photoshop 7 has enriched the user interface with smoother buttons and inherent cosmetic enhancements. Your workspace and the arrangement of palettes and toolbars can now be saved and used later by different users. Underneath this new interface is a range of new tools such as the intuitive visual image management system. You can browse through your image files here in a thumbnail view with an intuitive Explorer-like navigation interface, which also displays a preview and information about the image. Another enhancement is the bloated number of over 50 brush presets. The newly incorporated AutoColor com-

mand is an effective one-click colour correction tool. With numerous additional functionalities such as the improved Liquefy tool and the Pattern Maker, the creative possibilities are widespread, making Photoshop 7 a clear winner.



Adobe Photoshop 7

Adobe Systems India Pvt Ltd,
Ph: 914532026

The verdict: With plenty of enhancements such as the visual image management interface, many new brush settings and tools that simplify commonly used tasks, Photoshop still remains the best in image

